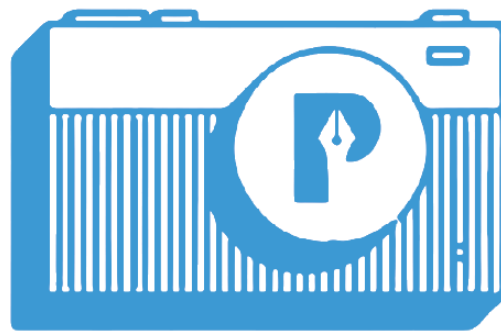




# IPC

## International Press Corps

### Agenda: Journalism and Photography



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## JOURNALISM

Reporters are known as the writers of the first draft of history. A good Reporter is known to have a way with words, inhered with thorough knowledge of the issue at hand, deft at communication and is Professional while exuding confidence.<sup>1</sup>

Each Reporter at IntraMUN shall be expected to embody these principles to the greatest extent possible. Each Reporter shall be assigned a committee and be expected to keenly observe, analyse and report on the themes discussed by the various delegates.

## RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

1. Read the background guide thoroughly, but do not be confined to the same. They are usually the starting points for one's research.
2. Get updated on the recent events occurred in, and themes relevant with, the agenda of the committee that you are assigned to report on. Moreover, try atleast cursorily, to skim through the background guide of the same.
3. Study the political, legal, social and economic aspects of the agenda. Go through articles, research papers or any relevant documents.
4. Reporters should comprehensively cover the committee, considering its diverse delegate stances and power dynamics.

<sup>1</sup>Essential qualities of a good journalist

<https://www.reva.edu.in/blog/essential-qualities-of-a-good-journalist>

<sup>2</sup>Inverted Pyramid: The Delicious News Writing Format That Produces Clear Stories, Every Time

<https://nickwolny.com/inverted-pyramid>

<sup>3</sup> Inverted Pyramid: Writing for Comprehension

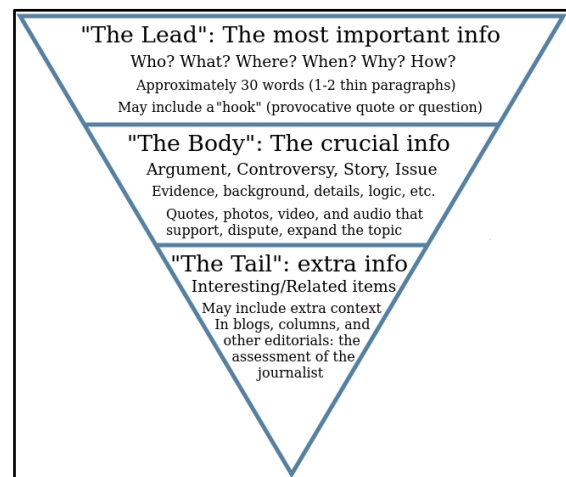
<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/inverted-pyramid/>

Review the country matrix, understand historical positions, and compare them with delegates' views. Note any adherence to or deviation from foreign policies and how power blocs' objectives unfold. This insight is crucial for writing informed articles, Op-Eds, and conducting effective interviews.

## ROLES AND REPORTING

### Articles

An article should follow the inverted pyramid structure, whereby, the most important information is written in the first paragraph(lead) followed by a paragraph or two dedicated to providing some nuance and/or crucial information(body) and ended with some non-essential background information and optionally a conclusion.<sup>2</sup>



An editorial is an essay in a newspaper or magazine that gives the opinions of its editors or publishers.

An editorial would differ from an article by the fact that it would contain the reporter's take on the issue at hand. Editorials do not have to contain any information on what happened in the council/committee but concerns the author's unique take on the subject. It should reflect high intellectual rigour and a comprehensive analysis of some pertinent topic with preferably a data-driven narrative.

Referring to newspapers and magazines like The Economist, The Wall Street Journal, The Atlantic and, the Financial Times would be highly recommended.

### **Word Limit: 300-350 words**

### **Press Conference**

One of the most important skills of a journalist is the art of asking informed questions. This skill shall be judged as Reporters would be given an opportunity to ask 3-5 questions to delegates in their respective committee/council. The scheme of asking questions would be indicated by the IPC head before the Press Conference commences and all the questions to be asked shall be pre-approved by the IPC head.

**It must be noted that the number of questions asked and the duration thereof, may be changed at the discretion of the IPC head.**

The key to asking great questions lies is often a determinant of the keenness with which the reporter has followed the deliberations of the committee and the thoroughness with which they have researched.

Furthermore, one must value open-endedness while asking questions as it helps elicit constructive answers.

## **STYLE**

It must be noted that the official writing style followed would be the AP Stylebook. Keep in the mind the following key writing principles:

1. **Abbreviations:** Spell out every single abbreviation, the first time it occurs in a news article. Henceforth, one may use the abbreviation,
2. **Lowercase:**
  - a. directional indicators,
  - b. the names of the seasons unless they are used in a proper name
  - c. formal titles that appear on their own or follow a name
3. **Capitalise** common nouns that are part of a name,
4. In general, spell out numbers one through nine while, use figures for numbers 10 on up,
5. It is recommended to use a semicolon to clarify a series that includes a number of commas,
6. Use a person's full name on the first reference,
7. To form a plural of a single letter, use "s" and an apostrophe.

For the detailed AP format, visit <https://www.apstylebook.com/>

## **SUBMISSION GUIDELINES**

### **Submission Deadline**

The deadline for submission will be decided before the commencement of committee sessions. Submissions must be on time, failure to do so will lead to a deduction in marks.

The naming convention to be followed is: 'name\_committee\_session-Number\_typeOfSubmission'

## THEMATIC PHOTOGRAPHY

### Introduction

Thematic photography means choosing a specific subject or idea to focus on when taking pictures. Instead of shooting randomly, one picks a theme, like "hands at work" in a busy market. This focus helps eliminate distractions and saves time. By knowing what to look for, a photographer can target specific locations and subjects. This approach also helps develop a unique photography style over time. Ultimately, thematic photography provides direction and leads to a stronger, more cohesive body of work.

### Themes

#### Diplomatic Duel

Capture scenes in which two delegates are engaged in passionate debate during the committee sessions. Try to look for intense eye contact and assertive body language. The best shots often come during heated Q&A sessions.

#### Silent Strategies

Photograph the quiet but crucial moments of note-passing and hushed planning during committee sessions. Try to focus on small groups gathered during unmoderated caucus, secret alliance formations, or delegates exchanging quick notes. These shots depict the real diplomatic work that happens between formal speeches.

#### Alliance Architecture

Document how the committee room naturally divides into distinct groups as discussions progress. Capture the physical patterns formed by different blocs as some delegates come together in tight circles. These shots tell the story of coalition formation.

### Podium Presence

Speeches establish the tone for committee proceedings and demonstrate a delegate's understanding of their foreign policy, particularly during General Speakers' List (GSL) sessions. During these speeches, pay close attention to the delegates and capture their confident hand gestures, commanding posture, and the attention they receive from other delegates.

### Moments of Mediation

Mediation is where a neutral third party facilitates dialogue between conflicting parties to reach a peaceful resolution. It is considered a fundamental and essential tool in the practice of diplomacy. Find scenes in which a mediator, usually a member of the executive board, steps in to bridge disagreements between delegates or opposing blocs. These shots show diplomacy in action.

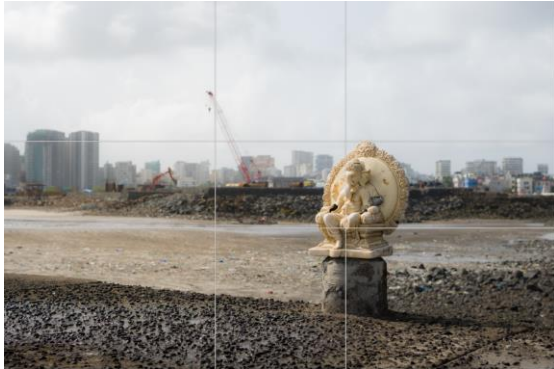
## COMPOSITION TIPS

Composition refers to how elements are arranged within a photograph, including but not limited to the main subject. It is distinct from the subject itself, as it encompasses the entire frame. The human eye naturally prefers images with a sense of order and balance, while chaotic compositions are often less appealing. Good composition creates harmony and visual interest, while poor composition can detract from the image's impact. To improve composition, it's essential to understand and practice the various guidelines—often referred to as "rules"—that help structure an image effectively, keeping in mind that these are more flexible guidelines than strict rules.

### Common Composition Techniques

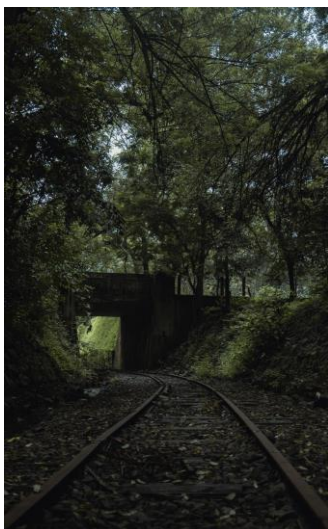
#### The Rule of Thirds

The rule of thirds suggests dividing the image into nine equal sections, placing the subject at one of the intersecting points rather than the center. This creates a more visually engaging composition, as the human eye tends to be drawn to off-center points of interest, making the image feel more balanced and dynamic.



### Leading Lines

Lines, whether straight, diagonal, or curved, guide the viewer's eye through the photo. Leading lines can direct attention to specific elements, adding depth and drama. Diagonal lines, in particular, can create dynamic movement and a sense of infinity in an image.



### Framing

In photography, a “natural frame” doesn’t always mean a literal frame. It can refer to elements like doorways, arches, or tree branches that isolate

the subject and direct the viewer's attention. By using natural frames, you can emphasize your subject and create a visual focus within the image.



### Symmetry

Symmetry involves balancing both sides of an image to create harmony. It allows for breaking the rule of thirds and can be found in both nature and man-made elements. Look for symmetrical patterns, particularly those with strong lines or curves, which enhance the visual appeal of the image.



### Viewpoint

The viewpoint can dramatically alter the mood of a photograph. For example, shooting a child from

above makes them appear smaller or less significant, while shooting at eye level offers an equal perspective, and shooting from below can create a sense of dominance. Perspective also affects the perceived size of objects, such as emphasizing the height of a tree by shooting upward.



### Understanding Technical Settings For Composition

**Managing ISO and Noise:** In a low-light environment like a classroom with artificial lighting, you might need to raise your ISO to capture enough light. However, increasing ISO can introduce noise (grain) into the image. A good starting point might be ISO 800-1600 but test in your specific lighting conditions to find the optimal balance. You could also use noise reduction softwares during post-processing if necessary.

**Slowing Down Shutter Speed:** If you're dealing with light banding or flicker from artificial lights, slowing down the shutter speed can help reduce this effect. Artificial lighting, especially fluorescent or LED lights, may cause a flickering effect that appears as horizontal bands across your images. A slower shutter speed can help smooth out this flickering. However, be mindful of motion blur if your subject is moving. A tripod can help stabilize the shot if you're using slower shutter speeds.

**White Balance Adjustment:** Cool, white/blue artificial lights often result in images with a cold, unnatural color cast. Adjust your camera's white balance to compensate for this.

**Grid Lines for Composition:** To help with compositional balance and alignment, enable the grid lines on your camera's viewfinder or screen. These lines divide the frame into thirds, both horizontally and vertically, which aligns with the rule of thirds. Using grid lines can assist in positioning your subject or focal point at key intersections, creating a more dynamic and visually pleasing image.

### GRADING CRITERIA

Each section will be scored out of a specific maximum total, and the final score will be a combination of the scores from each section.

#### Themes (5 photos total)

Capture one photo for each of the five aforementioned themes. Submissions will be graded based on:

**Accuracy:** Does the photo effectively depict the theme? Are the subject's facial expressions, body language, and overall mood clear and authentic?

**Composition and Technique:** Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing that enhances the emotional impact?

#### Organizing Committee (5-10 photos total)

Capture 5-10 photos of Organizing Committee (OC) members at work, focusing on candid moments and behind-the-scenes actions. Submissions will be graded based on:

**Storytelling:** Does the photo capture the behind-the-scenes action or effort of the Organizing

Committee? Does it provide insight into the OC's role and the event's inner workings?

**Composition and Technique:** Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing?

### Composition Types (5 photos total)

Submit 1 photo each for 5 different composition techniques: Rule of Thirds, Leading Lines, Framing, Symmetry, and Viewpoint.

Submissions will be graded based on:

**Execution:** Does the photographer effectively use the chosen compositional technique in a creative and visually striking way? Is the rule clearly incorporated into the shot?

**Technique:** Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing?

### Miscellaneous Photos (5 photos total)

Submit 5 miscellaneous photos that don't fit the other categories. Submissions will be graded based on:

**Creativity and Innovation:** Are the photos unique, imaginative, or taken from an interesting perspective? Do they offer a fresh approach to capturing the event?

**Composition and Technique:** Is the image technically well-executed with appropriate focus, exposure, and framing?

## SUBMISSION GUIDELINES

### Submission Deadline

The deadline for submission will be decided before the commencement of committee

sessions. Submissions must be on time, failure to do so will lead to a deduction in marks.

### Image Editing

Editing is not mandatory; however, if you choose to edit your images, please keep adjustments minimal. Avoid over-editing, such as excessive sharpening, saturation, or heavy filters. The goal is to enhance the photo while preserving its natural look and authenticity.

### Submission Method

All images must be uploaded to the provided drive link. Photographers are required to create their own folder and organize their photos into 4 separate folders, one for each category:

1. Emotions
2. Compositions
3. Miscellaneous
4. Organizing Committee (OC)

Name each photo according to its category and specific emotion or composition type. Example:

1. Emotion\_happiness\_1.jpg
2. composition\_ruleOfThirds\_1.jpg
3. Misc\_1.jpg
4. oc\_1.jpg

Please ensure your files are well-organized and clearly labeled to facilitate the grading process.